



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

BIXBY BRIDGE is now accessible from the south after Highway 1 reopened in both directions this month.

In a losing battle with climate change, can Highway 1 survive?

California marked a milestone this month with the return of an uninterrupted Highway 1 through the perilous, yet spectacular cliffs of Big Sur.

The famed coastal road was closed for more than three years after two major landslides buried the two-lane highway, and it took unprecedented engineering might and precarious debris removal to once again connect northern Big Sur with its southern neighbors.

But no one expects this will be the end of Highway 1's battle with the forces of nature, especially in a world facing the intensifying effects of human-caused climate change.

"We, in Big Sur, know to plan with a grain of salt," said Matt Glazer, executive director of Deetjen's Big Sur Inn, located near the northern end of the closure. "This is a snapshot in time, and the ever-

Reopening is a victory for Big Sur residents, but damage and costly repairs are increasingly common now

By Grace Toohey

changing coast of Big Sur is something that makes it beautiful."

A turbulent climate always has been the nemesis of Highway 1's splendor. The seaside road routinely has closed because of rockslides, mudflows, flooding, wildfires and coastal erosion, most notably in Big Sur but also in several sections from Malibu up through the North Coast.

But this latest closure — what appears to be the longest in Highway 1's 90-year history — raises new questions about how the highway can survive amid increasingly strong and unpredictable storms, seas and fires.

"If our storm and other conditions were normal, we would expect closures and losses at some points," said Michael Beck, director of UC Santa Cruz's Center for Coastal Climate Resilience. "The

Landlord faces rare criminal charges

The tenants of this 43-unit apartment building in downtown Los Angeles have typical complaints about their landlord, Nela Petrusan.

They claim she has not fixed plumbing issues, that she has turned off their hot water, that she allowed a roach infestation to fester and that she has failed to make repairs in an expedient manner.

They also have other — less typical — complaints.

One tenant claims Petrusan sprayed her with bear mace and that Petrusan's boyfriend torched her car, though Petrusan and her boyfriend deny that and the case is still under investigation. Another tenant said Petrusan swung a broom at her head. A third claims that Petrusan's pit bull attacked her, forcing her to get surgery.

Welcome to 1430 Wright

Wild allegations of violence fuel a war in a downtown L.A. building

By Noah Goldberg and Ruben Vives



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

NELA PETRUSAN, charged under L.A.'s Tenant Anti-Harassment Ordinance, denies any wrongdoing.

St.

Wedge within a gritty loop of the 10 and 110 freeway interchange, the century-old apartment building rises beside a cul-de-sac, in the shadow of the Los Angeles Convention Center. While thousands of Angelenos motor past the property every day, they are oblivious to the war raging inside between Petrusan and her tenants.

Amid the backdrop of a severe housing shortage and soaring L.A. rents, the battles at 1430 Wright St. are being fought in hallways and apartments and in the civil and criminal courts, where both sides trade wild allegations of violence and harassment that they claim make the building a nightmare.

"This is the most extreme situation that I've ever seen," said David Albright, a Los Angeles Tenants Union organizer who works with

Indie studios seeing lag in film, TV work

Owners of such facilities across L.A. are scrambling to stay afloat amid slump.

By Roger Vincent and Samantha Masunaga

Shep Wainright sure would like to rent you a fancy new soundstage.

Last week, he opened a \$230-million movie and television studio on the edge of the Arts District in downtown Los Angeles nestled alongside the dramatic new 6th Street Bridge.

The state-of-the-art complex has five soundstages, offices and other proper movie studio features such as a mill, commissary and base camp.

"We just had all the major networks, all the major streaming platforms walk through this facility and they can't believe how nice it

is," said Wainright, managing partner of East End Studios.

But so far, no one has signed up to make a project at East End Studios' newest property, even as state and local leaders tout new tax incentives to boost the film industry.

"Everyone is doing their best to try to bring productions back to Los Angeles," Wainright said, "but it's pretty dire."

The challenges facing owners of local soundstages came into sharp relief last week when one of the largest landlords in Hollywood — Hackman Capital Partners — said it was turning over the historic Radford Studio Center in Studio City to Goldman Sachs.

After years of aggressive soundstage development across Southern California — fueled by a surge in TV production and low interest rates — the writing was on

Taxes in L.A. may go higher

City Council considers hikes on parking and vacation rentals. More may appear on ballots. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Rams' McVay deserves blame

Decisions by one of brightest coaches led to loss in NFC title game, Bill Plaschke writes. **SPORTS, B10**

The persistence of creativity

Five Altadena writers whose lives were upended by the Eaton fire reflect on loss. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Sunshine. L.A. Basin: 75/52. **B6**

Markets A11
Opinion Voices A12

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

7 85944 00200 5

Thousands of Kaiser workers go on strike

Nurses, therapists, others turn up heat with an open-ended walkout

By Suhauna Hussain



GARY CORONADO For The Times

REGISTERED nurse Milca Nunez, center, joins other healthcare workers picketing in Downey.

funding for the State Department and the Pentagon, as well as education, health, labor and transportation agencies. Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer (D-N.Y.) released a statement Monday calling on Republican leader John Thune (R-S.D.) to avert another shutdown by separating funding for Homeland Security from the full appropriations package.

"Senate Democrats have made clear we are ready to quickly advance the five appropriations bills separately from the DHS funding bill before the January 30th deadline. The responsibility to prevent a partial government shutdown is on Leader Thune and Senate Republicans," Schumer said.

The standoff also revealed fractures among GOP lawmakers, who called for a federal and state investigation into the shooting and congressional hearings for federal officials to explain their tactics — demands that have put unusual pressure on the Trump administration.

[See Standoff, A7]

Trump sends new overseer to Minnesota

The switch comes as scrutiny mounts over latest killing by U.S. immigration agents.

By Jenny Jarvie

As federal immigration tactics face mounting legal and political scrutiny after U.S. Border Patrol agents fatally shot a Minneapolis man over the weekend, President Trump announced Monday that he was dispatching his border advisor Tom Homan to Minnesota.

Until now, Border Patrol commander Gregory Bovino has overseen the federal government's immigration crackdown in Minnesota. But as the Trump administration's Department of Homeland Security faces widespread criticism for its aggressive tactics since it launched Operation Metro Surge in December, Trump signaled Monday that he could be shifting strategy as he deploys Homan to the region.

"He has not been involved in that area, but knows and likes many of the people there," Trump said of Homan on Truth Social.

"Tom is tough but fair, and will report directly to me."

In a sign that the Trump administration may be questioning its hard-line immigration approach in Minneapolis, Bovino and some federal agents are expected to leave the city as early as Tuesday, a source told the Associated Press.

Muzaffar Chishti — an attorney and immigration policy expert at the Migration Policy Institute, a Washington-based think tank — said no one knows what Trump will do next, but Homan's arrival in Minnesota marks a significant shift in the balance of power in the administration's immigration enforcement efforts.

"There was a big rift here between seasoned ICE officers and these new troopers," Chishti said. "This may become the moment where things begin to change, if not fully reverse. I would be surprised if we don't see some change."

Trump said Monday that he had a "very good call" with Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz, who called on the president this weekend to "pull the thousands of violent, untrained officers out of Minnesota."

[See Scrutiny, A7]

Shutdown looms over ICE budget